

LAPD'S FIRE RESPONSE WAS IN DISARRAY

The unprecedented scale of the Palisades disaster led to chaos, the department says.

By LIBOR JANY

The Los Angeles Police Department has released a report that identifies several shortcomings in its response to the devastating Palisades fire, including communication breakdowns, inconsistent record-keeping and poor coordination at times with other agencies — most notably the city's Fire Department.

The after-action report called the January blaze a “once in a lifetime cataclysmic event” and praised the heroic actions of many officers, but said the LAPD's missteps presented a “valuable learning opportunity” with more climate-related disasters likely looming in the future.

LAPD leaders released the 92-page report and presented the findings to the Police Commission at the civilian oversight panel's public meeting Tuesday.

The report found that while the Fire Department was the lead agency, coordination with the LAPD was “poor” on Jan. 7, the first day of the fire. Though personnel from both agencies were working out of the same command post, they failed to “collectively establish a unified command structure or identify shared objectives, missions, or strategies,” the report said.

Uncertainty about who was in charge was another persistent issue, with more confusion sown by National Guard troops that were deployed to the area. Department leaders were given no clear guidelines on what the Guard's role would be when they arrived, the report said. [See Report, A8]



ERIC THAYER Los Angeles Times



ADAM GRAY Bloomberg

A VOTER, top, makes a decision at a polling place in Los Angeles' Union Station on Tuesday. Above, New York mayoral candidate Zohran Mamdani campaigns.

Conservative justices face tariff test

Supreme Court to hear challenge to Trump's claim of sweeping powers

By DAVID G. SAVAGE

WASHINGTON — The Supreme Court's conservatives face a test of their own making this week as they decide whether President Trump had the legal authority to impose tariffs on imports from nations across the globe.

At issue are import taxes that are paid by American businesses and consumers.

Small-business owners had sued, including a maker of “learning toys” in Illinois and a New York importer of wines and spirits. They said Trump's ever-changing tariffs had severely disrupted their businesses, and they won rulings declaring the president had exceeded his authority.

On Wednesday, the justices will hear their first major challenge to Trump's claims of unilateral executive power. And the outcome is likely to turn on three doctrines that have been championed by the court's conservatives.

First, they say the Constitution should be interpreted based on its original meaning. Its opening words say: “All legislative powers ... shall be vested” in Congress, and the elected representatives “shall have the power to lay and collect taxes, duties, imposes and excises.”

Second, they believe the laws passed by Congress should be interpreted based on their words. They call this “textualism,” which rejects a more liberal and open-ended approach that included the general purpose of the law.

Trump and his lawyers say his sweeping “Liberation Day” tariffs were authorized by the International Economic Emergency Powers Act. [See Tariffs, A8]

DICK CHENEY, 1941 – 2025

As vice president, he crafted response to Sept. 11 attacks

The firm-jawed former secretary of Defense was unapologetic backer of the wars in Afghanistan and Iraq

By James Oliphant and James Gerstenzang



DAVID HUME KENNERLY Getty Images

POWERFUL ADVISOR

The chief strategist for President George W. Bush, Cheney redrew the lines that defined the vice presidency.

Richard B. Cheney, the former vice president of the United States who was the architect of the nation's longest war as he plotted President George W. Bush's thunderous global response to the 9/11 terrorist attacks, has died.

Vexed by heart trouble for much of his adult life, Cheney died Monday night from complications of pneumonia and cardiac and vascular disease, according to a statement from his family. He was 84.

“For decades, Dick Cheney served our nation, including as White House Chief of Staff, Wyoming's Congressman, Secretary of Defense, and Vice President of the United States,” the statement said. “Dick Cheney was a great and good man who taught his children and grandchildren to love our country, and to live lives of courage, honor, love, kindness, and fly fishing. We are grateful beyond measure for all Dick Cheney did for our country. And we are blessed beyond measure to have loved and been loved by this noble giant of a man.”

To supporters and detractors alike, Cheney was widely viewed as the engine that drove the Bush White House. His two-term tenure capped a lifetime of public service, both in Congress and on behalf of four Republican presidents.

It often fell to Cheney, not Bush, to make an assertive, unapologetic case [See Cheney, A7]



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

JOE RINAUDO tinkers with his photoplayer, an instrument that would accompany silent movies.

Preserving the sound of the silent movie era

By HANNAH SEO

If you walked past Joe Rinaudo's house in La Crescenta-Montrose, you probably wouldn't think anything extraordinary of it.

You wouldn't expect, for example, that it contains a 20-seat silent movie theater with a semi-complete organ, a mini museum dedicated to instruments of the silent cinema era, or an extensive basement workshop whirring with the sounds of power tools. And you certainly wouldn't expect the 74-year-old Rinaudo seated at a century-old instrument,

yanking pull-cords and pushing pedals while the machine in front of him whirs and whistles to a ragtime tune.

The instrument is Rinaudo's primary passion in life, an American invention that was key to the growing experience of silent films in the early 20th century but has been forgotten by most of the country: the photoplayer.

A cousin to self-playing player pianos, photoplayers automatically play music read out of perforated piano rolls. During their slim heyday — from their invention [See Rinaudo, A11]

More election coverage online

For Tuesday's key results, go to latimes.com and latimes.com/e-newspaper.

N.Y. and others vote in harbinger elections

Races for New Jersey and Virginia governor are also seen as a referendum on Trump.

By KEVIN RECTOR AND SUMMER LIN

NEW YORK — Voters were casting ballots in high-stakes elections on both coasts Tuesday, including for mayor of New York, new congressional maps in California and governor in both New Jersey and Virginia, states whose shifting electorates could signal the direction of the nation's political winds.

For voters and political watchers alike, the races have taken on huge importance at a time of tense political division, when Democrats and Republicans are sharply divided over the direction of the nation. Despite President Trump not appearing on any ballots, some viewed Tuesday's races as a referendum on him and his volatile second term in the White House.

In New York, self-described democratic socialist Zohran Mamdani, 34, was favored to win the mayoral race after winning the Democratic ranked-choice mayoral primary in June. Such a result would shake up the Democratic establishment and rile Republicans in near equal measure, serving as a rejection of both former Gov. Andrew Cuomo, a more establishment Democrat and Mamdani's leading opponent, and Trump, who has warned that a Mamdani win would destroy the city.

On election eve, Trump warned that a Mamdani win would disrupt the flow of federal dollars to the city and took the dramatic step of endorsing Cuomo over Curtis Sliwa, the Republican in the race.

“If Communist Candidate Zohran Mamdani wins the Election for Mayor of New York City, it is highly unlikely that I will be contributing Federal Funds, other than the very minimum as required, to my beloved first home, because of the fact that, as a Communist, this once great City has ZERO chance of success, or even survival!” Trump wrote Monday on his social media platform.

A vote for Sliwa “is a vote for Mamdani,” the president added. “Whether you personally like Andrew Cuomo or not, you really have no choice. You must vote for him, and hope he does a fantastic job. He is capable of it, Mamdani is not!”

Mamdani, a Ugandan-born naturalized U.S. citizen and New York state assemblyman who defeated Cuomo in the primary, has promised a brighter day for New Yorkers with better public transportation, more affordable housing and high-quality child care if he wins. He has slammed billionaires and some of the city's monied interests, which have lined up against [See Races, A6]

Undocumented UC students win

The system says it faces “legal risks” after court refuses to back hiring ban. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Aging Dodgers must run it back

Stars are in 30s now, but roster should stand pat, Dylan Hernández writes. **SPORTS, B10**

Elon Musk, the trillionaire?

A Tesla pay package up for a shareholder vote could make him the first. **BUSINESS, A9**

Weather

Low clouds clearing. L.A. Basin: 71/54. **B5**

Markets **A10**
Opinion Voices **A14**

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